



5-Minute Wake-Up Routine

A gentle, no-equipment routine to loosen your spine, hips, shoulders, and ankles before the day gets busy.

1



Deep Breathing + Overhead Reach — 30 seconds

Stand tall, inhale as you reach both arms overhead, then exhale as you lower them.

Form cue: Keep your ribs stacked over your hips.

Modification: Perform seated on the edge of your bed.

2



Shoulder Rolls — 30 seconds

Roll your shoulders slowly backward for 15 seconds, then forward for 15 seconds.

Form cue: Make the circles smooth and relaxed.

Modification: Use smaller circles if your shoulders feel stiff.

3



Standing Thoracic Rotations — 45 seconds

Place your hands across your chest and gently rotate from side to side.

Form cue: Keep your hips facing forward and rotate through your upper back.

Modification: Sit in a chair with both feet planted.

4



Cat-Cow — 45 seconds

On hands and knees, alternate between gently rounding and extending your spine.

Form cue: Move one section of your spine at a time and breathe slowly.

Modification: Place your hands on a countertop and perform the same spinal movement standing.

5



Hip-Hinge Good Mornings — 45 seconds

Place your hands on your hips, soften your knees, push your hips backward, then stand tall.

Form cue: Keep your back long and feel the stretch through your hamstrings.

Modification: Reduce the range and hold onto a chair.

6



Alternating Knee Drives — 45 seconds

Stand tall and slowly lift one knee toward your chest, then switch sides.

Form cue: Brace your core and avoid leaning backward.

Modification: Hold onto a wall or chair for balance.

7



Ankle Rolls + Calf Raises — 45 seconds

Roll each ankle for a few seconds, then finish with slow calf raises.

Form cue: Press evenly through the balls of your feet.

Modification: Keep both hands on a sturdy surface.

8



Morning Squat-to-Reach — 45 seconds

Sit your hips back into a comfortable squat, stand tall, and reach overhead.

Form cue: Keep your chest lifted and knees tracking over your toes.

Modification: Squat down to the edge of your bed or a chair.

Finish with one slow breath in, one long breath out, and remind yourself: you do not need a perfect morning—just a little movement to get started.